

Regular Meeting
October 19, 2015
School Committee Meeting
Council Chambers

The Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor McGlynn in the City Hall Council Chambers at 7:00 p.m. Those present were Ms. Cugno, Ms. DiBenedetto, Mr. Falco, Mr. Scarpelli, Mr. Skerry, Mayor McGlynn and Superintendent Belson. Ms. Van der Kloot was absent.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to suspend the rules to take the papers out of order

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Medford's National Merit Scholars

Superintendent Belson announced that seven Medford High School students have been named National Merit Scholars. One student Ian Adams was given the high honor of being named a national Merit Semifinalist. This position represents less than one percent of US high school seniors, and includes the highest scoring entrants in each state. To become a Finalist, Adams must submit a detailed scholarship application. In addition Serena Do, James Kostick, Sophia MacKay, Simona Miller, Simon Ospenson and Michael Walker were named National Merit Commended Students. We would like to congratulate these students on this huge accomplishment. Certificates were presented to the students from the School Committee.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry the report was accepted and placed on file.

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Off-Leash Recreation Area (Dog Park) Report

Mayor McGlynn said that the City of Medford commissioned a feasibility study to evaluate several locations for a "Dog Park." One of these locations is Riverbend Park which is directly behind the McGlynn School. Andrew Leonard from Leonard Design Associates presented the informative overview of the proposed site. His PowerPoint presentation included the details of the program and its goals including: the site to be used, separate large and small dog areas, shade structure and/or trees, ADA accessibility requirements, lighting, water supply for dog fountain and irrigation system, drainage system to meet city and state regulations and the design elements compatible with adjacent wetlands and flood plain.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno asked what the grant would provide. Mr. Leonard answered that they would have to submit the grant and see how it is accepted. Ms. Cugno asked who would maintain the site. Mr. Leonard said that in other cities it is the city's park department that would provide maintenance. The grant would provide maintenance costs for three years.

Ms. Cugno asked who will regulate and set rules? Mr. Leonard said that it is usually a community group who oversee the parks and set rules. He said that Medford has a group “Paws for Medford.” Ms. DiBenedetto is thrilled to have this coming. She commented that her dog doesn’t like the rice stones. Mr. Scarpelli said he has one concern – the smell of dog urine. Mr. Leonard said that the irrigation system set up to run once a day would rinse the area. The rice stones are best for odors so this should not be an issue. Mr. Falco stated he thinks it is a great idea and he supports it 100% but would like to know more about the tree removal/moving? Mr. Leonard answered that they will remove the dead trees and will replace them. They will move other trees as needed. Mr. Falco asked if the construction would be planned for the summer when school is not in session. Mr. Leonard said that would be the plan if all goes according to schedule.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to move approval.

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Mr. Skerry that the minutes of October 5, 2015 be approved:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:

Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Falco, Scarpelli, Skerry, McGlynn
Nay: 0
Absent: 1 Van der Kloot

On the motion of Mr. Falco that the Payrolls be approved:

Voted: That the Payrolls be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Falco, Scarpelli, Skerry, McGlynn
Nay: 0
Absent: 1 Van der Kloot

Report on NARCAN Protocol in Public Schools

Superintendent Belson reported that Naloxone (NARCAN) is a medication that reverses overdose from heroin or other opioids. At this time our police department has been trained in the use of NARCAN. Also Armstrong Ambulance personnel are able to administer this medication. The incidence of heroin (opioid) use by students in our schools is very small. However, the possibility exists that a student, staff member, or visitor to our schools could experience an overdose. During the period from 2010 – 2015 there have been zero deaths in Medford from opioids for individuals below the age of twenty. The highest numbers have occurred in the 20’s, 30’s and 40’s. Eighty-eight percent have been males. While an immediate call to 911 is the approved D.P.H. protocol, it is a medical emergency that must receive a rapid response. NARCAN can in

most instances reverse the overdose. The question is whether we should train our nursing staff so that they can respond rapidly while we wait for 911 services to arrive. We would also study best follow-up practices for any student or staff member who received a NARCAN treatment from our medical team. While DPH policy requires that there be referral counseling as part of the 911 response, a person may reject that intervention. This report is to provide the School Committee with information on the NARCAN option. Our goal is to inform you about the opiate issue and about the possibilities of having our nursing staff prepared to administer it. If we elect to do so it will take time to prepare our medical staff and to acquire the appropriate amount of medicine (NARCAN). There are many facets that must be explored. Tonight we are asking if the School Committee wants administration to fully investigate the option. Superintendent Belson introduced Toni Vento, Supervisor of Health Services to continue with the report. Ms. Vento continued by giving an overview of brain development and new findings. She also highlighted opiates and opioids, and the tools to reduce opioid deaths. She explained Narcan and how to respond to an opioid overdose.

Discussion:

Mayor McGlynn stated that he would like to go on record in favor of the school nurses carrying and administering Narcan. Ms. DiBenedetto also agrees. She said that she lost her brother to a heroin overdose fourteen years ago and she is so glad we as a school system are being pro active. She said that addiction starts between the ages of 12- 17 years of age. She wants to see this implemented immediately.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Falco to move approval.

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Also while under suspension Mr. Falco read the following resolutions presented by the School Committee:

Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee extend its congratulations to Mayor McGlynn and his team for the outstanding dedication ceremony in memory of Krystal Campbell, Martin Richard, Lingzi Lu and Officer Sean Collier. The event at the East Garden will be a significant memorial in celebration of their lives, the courage of the survivors, the heroism of the first responders and law enforcement officers, the skill of our medical teams and the commitment of all our affected communities to peace and justice.

Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee extend its congratulations to Mayor McGlynn and Sheila McGlynn on the birth of a granddaughter, Nora Cushing Brady. Nora is the daughter of Kathleen and Bill Brady.

Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee extend its congratulations to Bob and Paulette Van der Kloot on the occasion of their 35th wedding anniversary. Best Wishes and Congratulations.

Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee extend its congratulations to Robert Emmett Skerry Jr. on the occasion of his retirement with the state.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto, the resolutions were adopted.

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Aldo Scarpelli. Mr. Scarpelli was the father of School Committee member George Scarpelli and Medford Public Schools teacher Lisa Scire.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Sally Zampell. Mrs. Zampell was a secretary to the Superintendent for over twenty years and also the mother of retired athletic director Ron Zampell.

A moment of silence was held.

Update Report on Substance Abuse Prevention and Education Programs

Superintendent Belson reported that the Medford Public Schools working together with community and regional partners offers significant substance abuse prevention and education services to students and families. This report is offered to provide you with the latest information on the various programs and services that are in place and/or emergent in our community. This report will inform you regarding what we know about the behaviors and incidents of students in our community/schools and what we are doing to prevent and respond to substance abuse. This report will discuss the roll out of the Michigan Model; our school and community counseling/referral capacities; and the recommendation to implement MASBIRT (Massachusetts Screening Brief Intervention, Referral to Treatment) protocol. Superintendent Belson introduced Penny Funaiole. Ms. Funaiole gave an update on Medford's opioid deaths and overdoses for the years 2010-2015. She also went over the results of the Communities that Care Youth Survey. One of the important findings she said is that parental monitoring has increased based on a decline in the poor family management risk factor which is measured by two components: poor family supervision and poor family discipline. Alcohol and marijuana continue to be the drugs of choice. She said that across the board the middle school numbers are lower so prevention is working.

Mayor McGlynn left at 8:05 p.m.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno asked how do we get our research into the community? Rachel Perry answered by discussing the Michigan Model and its curriculum components. Ms. Cugno asked her what she wants parents to do? Ms. Perry answered that the middle school and elementary level have a home information piece after each lesson. Ms. Cugno asked how to we reach out to the 18-22 year olds. Ms. Funaiole said that through colleges and the

trades. Also general education in the community. Ms DiBenedetto asked how are we teaching/helping students that have parents or family members with addictions. Jeff Lappin answered by saying that each lesson has discussion on the topic and if needed adjustment counselors refer students elsewhere for support and help. This year they have had fifty-two referrals for counseling. Ms. DiBenedetto said that in the report the troubling fact for her is the mental health issue. Ms. Funaiole commented that they recently wrote a grant for mental health issues. Mr. Lappin commented that by adding additional adjustment counselors more support is in place. Ms. DiBenedetto suggested contacting the PTO to hold informational seminars. She wants outreach to parents. Mr. Scarpelli said that a couple of his former soccer players have overdosed. He feels that the report is cumbersome and suggested that a trifold brochure with the facts be made so that parents could easily read. Ms. Funaiole said that they have developed an informational graphic to reach out to coaches and parents.

At this time Superintendent Belson asked Ms. Vento to speak on SBIRT. Ms. Vento explained that SBIRT is screening, brief intervention, referral to treatments. There is a six question screening tool (CRAFT) used to identify high risk students, conducted during mandated screening for height/weight evidence-based assessment. High risk students are referred for counseling. Presently used in several public school districts including Gloucester, Natick, North Andover, Wilmington, Hudson, Northampton, Hadley. Training for school nurses, guidance and adjustment counselors is provided by Department of Public Health at no cost. Partner with Institute of Health and Recovery as part of Mystic Valley Public Health Company. Provide substance abuse counseling in the high school setting. Presently in place in Melrose, Malden and Reading public schools

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto, the report was accepted and placed on file.

Yes: 5

No: 0

Absent: 2

Recommendation to Accept Gift from MIDI Technologies Corporation to the Gay Straight Alliance of \$1500

Superintendent Belson stated that the Midi Technology Corporation of 200 Boston Avenue Medford, Massachusetts is donating \$1500 to the Gay Straight Alliance to offset the planned Washington trip recently approved by the Medford School Committee. The Von Schor family has been very generous to our schools over many years.

On the motion of Mr. Scarpelli, seconded by Ms. Cugno to accept the gift:

Yea: 5 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Falco, Scarpelli, Skerry

Nay: 0

Absent: 2 Van der Kloot, McGlynn

Report on College Fair and Financial Aid Night

Superintendent Belson reported that this year the guidance department will host the annual college fair on Wednesday, October 21st in the main lobby of Medford High School from 6:30 – 8:30 p.m. Over 100 colleges and universities are signed up to participate. Prior to the college fair the special education department will be hosting an event in the library focused upon helping students with disabilities make the transition from high school to college. This program will begin at 5:30 p.m. On Wednesday,

November 4, 2015 the guidance department will hold its annual Financial Aid Night in the Caron Theater beginning at 7:00 p.m. The program will feature a representative from MEFA (Massachusetts Educational Financing Authority) who will cover the details of the college financial aid process including the FAFSA and CSS profiles which are fundamental to acquiring scholarship and loan assistance. The above two event programs are open to all but it is particularly important for students and families of juniors and seniors. Colleges and universities are expensive but there is significant opportunity to acquire assistance especially if students and families start early. Managing the cost of college and reducing post college debt are important goals that should be pursued early.

On the motion of Mr. Scarpelli the report was accepted and placed on file:

Yes: 5

No: 0

Absent: 2

Follow-up Report on Common Core

Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson presented the report. Ms. Nelson said that the intent of this follow-up report is to provide additional information about the Common Core as well as analysis of its strengths over previous Massachusetts standards for ELA and mathematics. The first frameworks were written by educators for all content areas with the intention of being revised every five years. The only ones that have been revised on a regular basis are ELA and math. Prior to the publication of the Common Core teams of educators in Massachusetts were already at work in 2009 revising the 2004 ELA and math curriculum frameworks. The work of these teams was halted as the state anticipated the publication of the Common Core. The Common Core was reviewed by many constituents and available to the public for comment. The positive comments outweighed the negative. Although the CCSS were adopted in their entirety DESE was allowed to add additional standards and materials in developing their new Curriculum Frameworks for English Language Arts and Curriculum Frameworks for Mathematics. Once the Common Core was adopted the state committees of educators went back to work incorporating the CCSS into the new versions of the Massachusetts Frameworks for ELA and the Massachusetts Frameworks for mathematics; both were completed and adopted by the Board of Education in 2011. Some of the benefits include since CCSS standards will be used in most states students with high mobility will be positively impacted if they move from state to state, in states with less rigorous curricula, CCSS raise the level of expectations for all students throughout all states that have adopted the standards, because the CCSS are internationally benchmarked, our standards will be comparable to standards in other countries. CCSS focus on increasing critical thinking and problem-solving skills of our students. These are skills required of the current and future work place. CCSS also emphasizes skills such as listening and speaking which are important career and lifelong skills. Ms. Nelson also discussed the benefits of the ELA and math frameworks.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto commented that there is so much work to take the standards and break down each grade level, making sure all students meet all requirements to move on the next grade. Dr. Ricciardelli said that it is time consuming to go thru the standards and come up with lesson plans.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto the report was accepted and placed on file:

Yes: 5
No: 0
Absent: 2

Report on Professional Development Day November 3, 2015

Director of Curriculum Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli presented the report. She stated that the first of two professional development days for the 2015-2016 school year for educators will take place on Tuesday, November 3rd. Classes will not be in session and therefore students will not report to school on this day. Medford High School will be the host site for a majority of the day's activities which include topics in educator evaluation, technology and student information systems. The McGlynn School will host a smaller group for the Safety-Care Behavioral Safety Training program. All professional development offerings include an opportunity for educator feedback. This feedback is important to the district as it is used to adjust future offerings to ensure that the district's offerings meet the needs of our staff.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto commented that an important piece of the day is the training on School Brains which will be used as an outreach to parents. She also asked if anything is done for support staff including secretaries and custodians. Superintendent Belson said that the paraprofessionals are included in the activities for the day. Ms. Velie has a program planned for secretaries. Ms. DiBenedetto said that moving forward she would like to see all staff included on professional day.

On the motion of Ms. Skerry the report was accepted and placed on file:

Yes: 5
No: 0
Absent: 2

Financial Report

Director of Finance and Administration Pat Velie presented the report. Ms. Velie began by stating that the general fund budget is 26.65% expended. Currently eight teachers are on maternity leave with four pending. We currently have a few replacement paraprofessional positions still in the process of hiring. The 465 chairs have been delivered and installed at the buildings. The online payment system is up and running as scheduled. The summer fun program netted a profit of \$31,232.36 which will be used to offset community schools. Summer school ran for thirty days and the revolving fund accepted fees which offset the cost of teachers. Technology upgrades are continuing as planned. Training sessions and mentors are forming to complement the implementation of the new student information management system, School Brains. Security cameras are in the quote process to replace out of service units in needed locations. The telephones change over is on schedule. The telephone transition success can be attributed to our vendor DSCI/Comtel working closely with Allan Arena. The Medford Public Schools utilizes eighteen buses. Routes have been reviewed for use and crowding. Currently, no stops have been removed, but some have been adjusted for safety concerns, timing or to minimize crowding. The heating season has begun and is on in the buildings. National Grid is currently our natural gas supplier and distributor and we are not contracted. The

city relies on a consultant to monitor this market. The first quarter of the school year is busy with grant closeouts and preparation to complete the states end of year report. FY 16 is progressing as expected.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto asked if the summer school fees offset the teachers salaries . Is it in the red or black? She also asked once again for a breakdown of the community schools budget including rentals and what is being charged. Ms. Velie indicated that no student is turned away because of financial reasons. Mr. Skerry asked for a report on unemployment payouts. Mr. Falco asked for an update on the crossing guard situation. Ms. Velie said that she provided the information that was requested by the DCR and is still awaiting a final reply. Mr. Falco suggested involving State Representative Paul Donato in the situation. Ms. DiBenedetto asked for an update on the musical instruments. Mr. Falco asked if Ms. Velie has any concerns at this time? She answered not at this time.

On the motion of Ms. Scarpelli the report was accepted and placed on file:

Yes: 5
No: 0
Absent: 2

Old Business

Resolution submitted by Ms. Van der Kloot on October 5, 2015

On the motion of Ms. Cugno to accept the resolution seconded by Mr. Scarpelli:

Yes: 5
No: 0
Absent: 2

On the motion of that meeting be adjourned at 9:40 p.m.

Respectfully submitted:

Robert E. Skerry Jr
Secretary

